Seventy Moseses: The Spirit Shared, The Burden Lifted

> *Key Verse: "And the LORD said unto Moses, Gather unto me seventy men of the elders of Israel, whom thou knowest to be the elders of the people, and officers over them; and bring them unto the tabernacle of the congregation, that they may stand there with thee. And I will come down and talk with thee there: and I will take of the spirit which is upon thee, and will put it upon them; and they shall bear the burden of the people with thee, that thou bear it not thyself alone." (Numbers 11:16–17, KJV)*

Moses sat to judge the people from morning until evening. The line never ended. Fathers brought disputes over inheritance. Mothers brought complaints about neighbors. Men brought questions about the law. And Moses, the one man who spoke face to face with the One God, bore it all alone. His father-in-law Jethro saw it and said plainly: "Thou wilt surely wear away, both thou, and this people that is with thee: for this thing is too heavy for thee; thou art not able to perform it thyself alone" (Exodus 18:18, KJV). Jethro's counsel was practical: appoint rulers of thousands, hundreds, fifties, and tens (Exodus 18:21, KJV). Moses did it. But practical delegation is not the same as spiritual impartation. Jethro could give Moses a system. Only the One God could give Moses a shared spirit.

That is the difference between organization and anointing. You can organize a burden without ever transferring the power to carry it. And that is exactly what the One God did at the tabernacle: "I will take of the spirit which is upon thee, and will put it upon them" (Numbers 11:17, KJV). Think of it. Seventy Moseses. The same spirit that rested on the one man who saw the back of God, who stretched his rod over the Red Sea, who stood between the living and the dead when the plague raged—that same spirit was placed upon seventy elders. The burden for the one God doctrine was no longer carried by one set of shoulders. It was multiplied. The one God did not create a committee. He created a company of prophets. Moses gathered the seventy and set them around the tabernacle. "And the LORD came down in a cloud, and spake unto him, and took of the spirit that was upon him, and gave it unto the seventy elders: and it came to pass, that, when the spirit rested upon them, they prophesied, and did not cease" (Numbers 11:25, KJV).

They did not cease. The spirit did not come and go like a fleeting emotion. It rested. It remained. This was not a momentary ecstatic experience; it was an abiding equipping. The same spirit that was upon Moses now rested upon seventy. The burden for keeping the people

holy, for moving them toward Canaan, for judging between brother and brother, for standing against the fear of giants and the lure of Egypt—that burden was now shared. And then something even more remarkable happened. Two men, Eldad and Medad, had been written among the seventy but had not gone out to the tabernacle. They remained in the camp. And the spirit rested upon them also, and they prophesied in the camp (Numbers 11:26, KJV). Joshua, loyal and protective of Moses' authority, said, "My lord Moses, forbid them." But Moses answered with a longing that should echo in every generation of believers: "Enviest thou for my sake? would God that all the LORD'S people were prophets, and that the LORD would put his spirit upon them!" (Numbers 11:29, KJV).

Moses did not want a monopoly on the Spirit. He wanted an army of Spirit-filled people. He wanted the one God doctrine carried not by one prophet but by a whole nation. He wanted every Israelite to know the One God so intimately that the burden would be light. Now fast-forward to the upper room. Jesus stands with His disciples, and He speaks words that echo Moses' longing. "Nevertheless I tell you the truth; It is expedient for you that I go away: for if I go not away, the Comforter will not come unto you; but if I depart, I will send him unto you" (John 16:7, KJV). The word "Comforter" is the Greek Parakletos—one called alongside to help. It is the same concept Moses experienced: a burden-bearer, a helper, one who comes alongside. Jesus is saying, in effect: "I have been your Moses. I have carried you, taught you, judged for you, protected you. But the time has come for the spirit that is upon me to be shared with you."

"And I will pray the Father, and he shall give you another Comforter, that he may abide with you for ever; Even the Spirit of truth; whom the world cannot receive, because it seeth him not, neither knoweth him: but ye know him; for he dwelleth with you, and shall be in you. I will not leave you comfortless: I will come to you" (John 14:16–18, KJV). Did you catch that? "I will come to you." Jesus does not send a separate person. He comes Himself in the Spirit. The one God who put on flesh now comes to dwell in His people by His Spirit. The same Spirit that rested on Moses, the same Spirit that rested on the seventy, now rests on all who believe. On the day of Pentecost, the promise was fulfilled. "And they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance" (Acts 2:4, KJV). Not seventy elders. Not one prophet. All of them. The longing of Moses—"would God that all the LORD'S people were prophets"—was answered in a rushing mighty wind and cloven tongues of fire. The one God doctrine was no longer carried by a select few. It was carried by a Spirit-filled church.

This is the vision for the church. You are not meant to carry the burden of the gospel alone. You are not meant to be the only one praying, the only one witnessing, the only one standing for the one God doctrine while the world mocks. The Spirit has been shared. The same Spirit that raised Jesus from the dead dwells in you (Romans 8:11, KJV). The same Spirit that rested on Moses now rests on you. And when the burden becomes heavy—when the family is falling apart, when the job is crushing, when the temptation is overwhelming, when the enemy whispers that you cannot go on—remember the tabernacle. Remember the seventy. Remember that the one God never intended for you to bear it alone. He takes of the Spirit that is upon Christ and puts it upon His people. He makes you a company of prophets. He makes you seventy Moseses.

The burden for keeping the church holy is not the pastor's alone. The burden for moving toward the promised land is not the leader's alone. The burden for judging between truth and error is not the scholar's alone. The Spirit has been shared. You are a carrier of the one God doctrine. You are a Spirit-filled vessel. You are one of the seventy. Moses said, "Would God that all the LORD'S people were prophets." Jesus said, "I will send the Comforter." The one God said, "I will take of the spirit and put it upon them." And on the day of Pentecost, the promise was fulfilled. The Spirit is not a limited resource. The one God is not exhausted by sharing Himself. He multiplies. He fills. He rests. And He says to you, as He said to Moses: "Thou shalt not bear it alone."